



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*deho 'pi daiva-vaśa-gaḥ khalu karma yāvat
svārambhakaṃ pratisamīkṣata eva sāsuh |
taṃ sa-prapañcam adhirūṭha-samādhi-yogaḥ
svāpnaṃ punar na bhajate pratibuddha-vastuḥ | [BhP 11.13.36-37]
caturthī bhūmikā jñānaṃ tisraḥ syuḥ sādhanam purā |
jīvan-mukter avasthāstu parās tisraḥ prakīrtitāḥ |*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse

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GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage, drawing from both the Bhagavad Gita and the Bhagavata Purana, unveils a profound understanding of liberation and the journey of self-realization. It speaks of the body being subject to destiny, governed by the momentum of past actions, awaiting the fruition of its karmic seeds. As long as life remains, it observes the unfolding of its self-initiated karma. However, a soul established in unwavering Samadhi, a state of profound meditative absorption, and awakened to the true nature of reality, no longer succumbs to the illusory experiences of the dreamlike world.

The verses delineate the stages of spiritual progress, highlighting four distinct levels. The first three stages represent the disciplines or practices (sadhana) necessary to cultivate wisdom (jnana), which constitutes the fourth stage. Beyond these, the text introduces three more exalted states, described as the stages of liberation while living (jivan-mukti), signifying a transcendence of earthly limitations even within the physical body.

For you navigating the complexities of modern life, this means recognizing that while external circumstances may seem deterministic, driven by past choices, your conscious awareness holds the key to liberation. You can cultivate inner stillness through practices like meditation and self-reflection, gradually detaching from the incessant flow of thoughts and emotions that bind you to the cycle of suffering. This detachment doesn't mean becoming indifferent to the world but rather acting from a place of clarity and wisdom, unburdened by attachment and aversion. The journey towards self-realization is a gradual ascent, requiring patience, perseverance, and unwavering faith in your inherent potential for liberation. The wisdom found here guides you to recognize the transient nature of worldly experiences and to anchor your being in the eternal, unchanging Self. By doing so, you move beyond the dreamlike illusion and awaken to the true reality of your existence.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you truly awake and acting from your authentic Self, or are you still entangled in the dreamlike illusions of the world?